

SESSION 2

Apps, Settings & URL Routing

Topics Covered: Creating Django app, Project vs App, settings.py, urls.py, wsgi.py, Mapping URL to View, HttpResponse basics

Activities: Create app: accounts, Add it to INSTALLED_APPS, Create first view and URL

Task 1: Create a new Django app named 'playlists' inside your existing Django project and confirm that a playlists folder with standard files is generated.

Explanation & Approach: *Django applications encapsulate specific functionality (e.g., playlists, billing, auth). Apps can be reused across different Django projects.*

```
# Inside foodiehub_project directory:
python manage.py startapp playlists

# Generated directory structure:
# playlists/
# |  __init__.py
# |  admin.py
# |  apps.py
# |  migrations/
# |  models.py
# |  tests.py
# |  views.py
```

Task 2: Add 'playlists' to the INSTALLED_APPS list in your project's settings.py file so that Django recognizes it.

Explanation & Approach: *Django only recognizes templates, models, and migrations of apps that are explicitly registered in INSTALLED_APPS.*

```
# foodiehub_project/settings.py

INSTALLED_APPS = [
    'django.contrib.admin',
    'django.contrib.auth',
    'django.contrib.contenttypes',
    'django.contrib.sessions',
    'django.contrib.messages',
    'django.contrib.staticfiles',

    # Custom Apps
    'playlists',
]
```

Task 3: In `playlists/views.py`, write a function `home(request)` that returns an `HttpResponse` displaying 'Welcome to My Spotify Playlists!'.

Explanation & Approach: Views take an HTTP request object as parameter and return an HTTP response object containing HTML or text.

```
# playlists/views.py
from django.http import HttpResponse

def home(request):
    return HttpResponse("Welcome to My Spotify Playlists!")
```

Task 4: Configure your project's `urls.py` to map the URL path 'music/' to the home view you created in `playlists/views.py`, so visiting `http://localhost:8000/music/` shows your welcome message.

Explanation & Approach: Root URL routing delegates or maps incoming URL endpoints directly to view functions.

```
# foodiehub_project/urls.py
from django.contrib import admin
from django.urls import path
from playlists.views import home

urlpatterns = [
    path('admin/', admin.site.urls),
    path('music/', home, name='music_home'),
]
```

Task 5: Change the welcome message in your `playlists/views.py` home view to include your name, then restart the server and verify the update appears at `http://localhost:8000/music/`.

Explanation & Approach: Django development server automatically detects Python code changes and reloads without needing a manual server restart.

```
# playlists/views.py (Updated with Name)
from django.http import HttpResponse

def home(request):
    user_name = "Alex"
    return HttpResponse(f"<h1>Welcome to My Spotify Playlists, created by {user_name}</h1>")
```